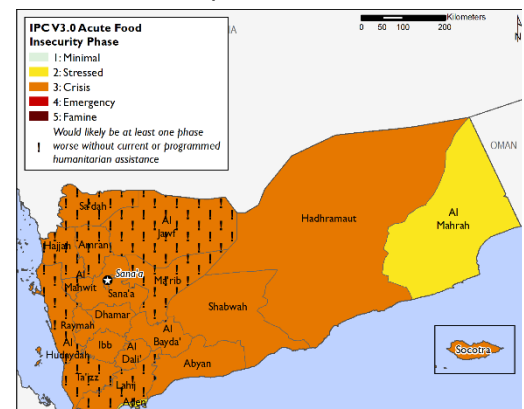


*Conflict, economy, and typical lean season expected to drive deteriorating food security in many areas*

## KEY MESSAGES

- In Yemen, conflict continues to drive poor macroeconomic conditions and disrupt livelihoods, reducing access to food and income. Though the recent harvest in some areas is expected to have improved food access for many households, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes remain widespread. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely to re-emerge in some areas in the February to May 2021 period as the lean season progresses. **Overall, an estimated 17 to 19 million people are expected to be in need of humanitarian food assistance throughout the projection period. While not the most likely scenario, Famine (IPC Phase 5) would be possible in the event that food imports are significantly disrupted for a prolonged period of time.**
- As of September 2020, the Yemeni Rial continued to depreciate in southern areas, contributing to further increases in already above-average prices of food and non-food commodities. The Rial depreciated by 4-5 percent in southern areas from August to September, reaching 793 YER/USD according to data from FAO. According to [data from UNVIM](#), food imports through the Red Sea Ports of Al Hudaydah and Salif have maintained relatively higher levels in recent months, with the July to September 2020 average 65 percent higher than the average from the preceding months from January to June 2020. Despite this, concern is mounting over the possible suspension of Yemen's import financing mechanism.
- Fuel shortages ongoing since June continue to impact Yemen, particularly in the north. From June to September 2020, average monthly fuel import levels were 60,000 MT, only one third of the January-May 2020 average. Prices of diesel and petrol remain 13 and 14 percent higher, respectively, than prices six months ago. This is impacting typical livelihood activities including in agriculture and transportation and is putting further upward pressure on food prices given the importance of fuel for agricultural production, food processing, and transport.

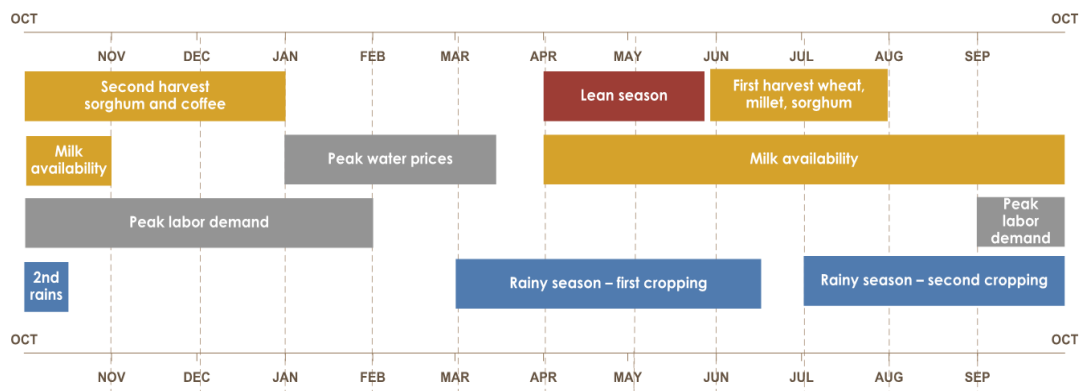
Current food security outcomes, October 2020



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is [IPC-compatible](#). [IPC-compatible](#) analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

## SEASONAL CALENDAR FOR A TYPICAL YEAR



Source: FEWS NET

## NATIONAL OVERVIEW

### Current Situation

Yemen continues to face the world's largest humanitarian crisis, with high levels of acute food insecurity driven by conflict, poor economic conditions, and reduced agricultural production. Over 17 million people are currently in need of humanitarian assistance to prevent food consumption gaps and protect livelihoods.

According to [data](#) from ACLED, high levels of conflict continue in Yemen, with a slight uptick in both armed clashes and airstrikes recorded at the national level in September 2020 (Figure 1). According to data from Intelyse, active conflict continues to disproportionately impact Al Jawf, Ma'rib, Al Bayda, Aden, southern areas of Al Hudaydah, and parts of Ta'izz, Al Dali', Abyan, and Hajjah (Figure 2). Conflict between the Southern Transitional Council (STC) and Hadi-backed forces has continued in the south.

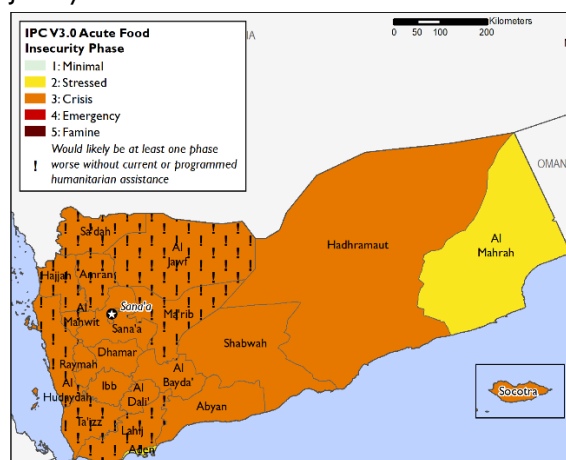
Widespread and persistent conflict across Yemen continues to disrupt typical livelihood activities and drive large-scale displacement. As of October 31, the International Organization for Migration (IOM) recorded a total [158,256 people \(26,376 households\) displaced in 2020](#) across the 13 of 24 governorates monitored. Given limited coverage, this is an underestimate of the total number displaced in Yemen. Of the monitored governorates, Ma'rib remains the governorate hosting the highest number of people who have been newly displaced in 2020 (12,064 households), largely driven by conflict in Ma'rib and Al Jawf.

Yemen's economy continues to be impacted by severe foreign currency shortages. In this context, the exchange rate has been depreciating—driven by the exchange rate in southern areas—since November/December 2019. According to FAO, the exchange rate in southern areas depreciated approximately 5 percent from August to September 2020, reaching 793 YER/USD. In northern areas, the exchange rate remained fairly stable on average. Deteriorating macroeconomic conditions continue to drive increasing food prices and reduced access to income for millions.

As of October 24, a total [2,064 cases](#) of COVID-19 were reported in Yemen according to OCHA, with only 30 new cases reported in the preceding month. Most cases have been reported in the southern governorates of Hadhramaut (959 cases), Ta'izz (303 cases), and Aden (286 cases). In northern areas, information about COVID-19 continues to be restricted. Overall, capacity for testing and treatment remains limited, with the number of cases likely to be a significant underestimate. Evidence of this is provided by the case fatality ratio of 29 percent, which is the highest in the world. A high case fatality ratio often indicates that only the most severe cases of a disease are being tested.

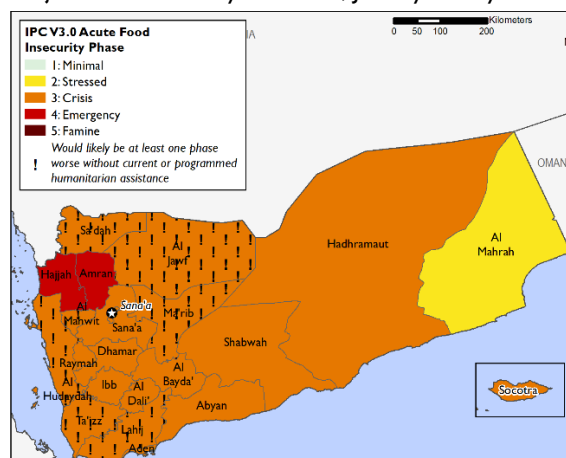
Fuel shortages ongoing since June 2020 in northern areas of Yemen continue to impact typical livelihood activities—including in the agriculture, fishing, transportation, processing, and manufacturing sectors—and are putting further upward pressure on food prices given the importance of fuel for food processing and transport. In September 2020, fuel imports through the Red Sea ports of Al Hudaydah and Salif totaled just [20,000 tons](#) according to data from UNVIM. This brings the June to September 2020 average (during the period of shortages) to 60,000 MT per month, which is only one third of the January to May 2020 monthly average (prior to the period of shortages). According to [news reports](#), a fuel tanker unloaded in Al Hudaydah on October 23. However, this is expected to provide only temporary relief amidst the ongoing blockade. At

Projected food security outcomes, October 2020 to January 2021



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, January to May 2021



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

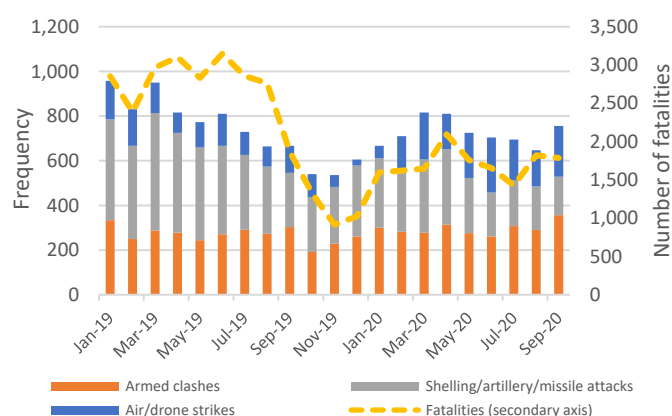
the national level, the average prices of diesel and petrol declined slightly—by 3 and 4 percent, respectively—between August and September according to FAO, though prices remained 13 and 14 percent higher, respectively, than prices six months ago. Shortages also continued to impact Aden and Al Bayda throughout the month of October, due to a blockade of oil ports in Aden by military protestors demanding salary payments. In Aden, the average prices of diesel and petrol increased by 6 and 3 percent between August and September.

According to data from UNVIM, food imports through the Red Sea Ports of Al Hudaydah and Salif have maintained relatively higher levels in recent months, with the July to September 2020 average 65 percent higher than the average from the preceding months from January to June 2020. Average monthly wheat and wheat flour imports through Yemen's main sea and land ports now stand at 269,000 per month between January and September 2020 according to FAO, which is similar to the FAO's estimated monthly import requirement for Yemen of approximately 267,000 per month. Despite this, concern is mounting over the possible suspension of Yemen's import financing mechanism that provides letters of credit to food importers, allowing them to access foreign currency at preferred exchange rates. The Sana'a Center reported in October that foreign currency exchange holdings from the Saudi deposit were less than \$200 million—an amount insufficient to cover one month of imports. The Sana'a Center also reported that, given this, there is a possibility that the CBY in Aden will suspend the letters of credit import financing mechanism in the coming few months, though this is not the expectation in FEWS NET's most likely scenario (see assumptions below). According to the World Bank's [Monthly Economic Update for October](#), there is growing evidence that the government deficit has been financed by the CBY overdraft facility.

Currently, harvesting activities are ongoing in many areas of Yemen. Overall, FAO projects that cereal production in 2020 will total 365,000 tons, including 160,000 tons of sorghum, 130,000 tons of wheat, 40,000 tons of millet, and 35,000 tons of other cereals. Total cereal production in 2020 is expected to be 5 percent below 2019 production levels and 25 percent below the five-year average. Compared to pre-conflict levels, this figure is even lower. In addition to the impacts of conflict, crops have been damaged this year by some localized flooding and desert locusts. FAO estimates that Yemen's total domestic cereal production contributes less than 20 percent of all utilization needs, while domestic production of wheat—Yemen's key staple—contributes 5-10 percent. As a result, Yemen is highly dependent on imports to meet its cereal needs, though local agricultural production of cereals and other food crops is expected to provide many poor households with limited food stocks and some income from crop sales in the post-harvest period. In addition, local agricultural production of food and cash crops provides many poor households with income-earning opportunities as laborers for better-off households.

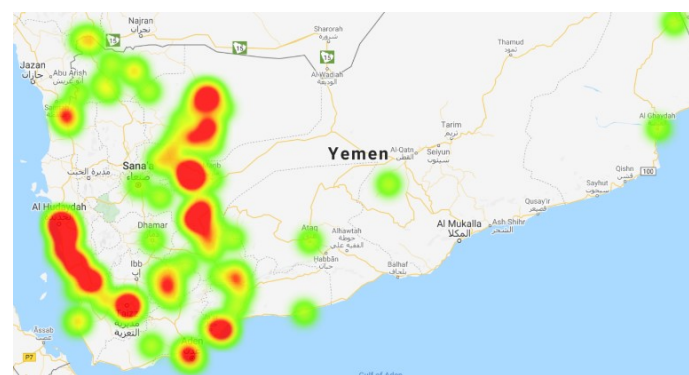
According to FAO data, the prices of most staple food commodities (and, consequently, the cost of the minimum food basket) have been generally increasing at the national level, with the cost of staple wheat flour 4 percent higher in September 2020 compared to three months ago, 13 percent higher compared to 6 months ago, and 26 percent higher

**Figure 1.** Monthly frequency of conflict events and fatalities in Yemen according to data from the Armed Conflict Location & Event Data Project (ACLED)



Source: FEWS NET, using data from ACLED

**Figure 2.** Relative frequency of key conflict incidents (armed clashes, shelling, and airstrikes) across Yemen, September 26 – October 19, 2020



Source: Intelyse

compared to the same time last year. Though prices of most staple food remained stable or increased only slightly at the national level between August and September 2020, this masks considerable variability at the governorate level. Between August and September, the price of staple wheat flour increased by 6-10 percent in Ma'rib, Sana'a City, Shabwah, Al Mahrah, Al Bayda, Amran, and Hadhramaut Coast. Meanwhile, according to FAO, wages for casual labor remained stable (increased by 2 percent) at the national level between August and September, while wages for agricultural labor increased by 4 percent. However, substantial differences again exist at the governorate level. Considering both food prices and wages, terms of trade (an indicator of purchasing power defined by the ratio of wheat flour prices to labor wages) for casual laborers declined by 4-7 percent from August to September in Al Hudaydah, Sana'a City, Lahij, and Hadhramaut Coast. Meanwhile, terms-of-trade for agricultural laborers declined by 4-7 percent in Al Hudaydah, Al Bayda, Sana'a City, and Shabwah.

Access to income remains constrained due to long-term impacts of the conflict on Yemen's economy, persistent government revenue shortages, and reduced remittances from Saudi Arabia due to impacts of reduced global oil prices and COVID-19 on the Saudi economy. Within Yemen, COVID-19 has been an additional shock on economic activity and income-earning in urban areas in recent months, though recovery is expected to have occurred since restrictions were eased. Due to government revenue shortages, payments of salaries for civil servants continue to be impacted by delays or non-payment. However, according to the World Bank's [Monthly Economic Update for October 2020 update](#), authorities in northern areas have disbursed half-month salaries to public sector workers under its controlled areas every other month in 2020, partially alleviating concerns about the southern government ceasing payment of salaries to northern areas at the end of 2019. Meanwhile, due to impacts of the global oil market and COVID-19 on Saudi Arabia's economy, income from international remittances is also expected to remain below average, though levels are expected to have recovered somewhat in recent months. According to the Cash Consortium of Yemen's [September 2020 Remittances Tracker](#), trends in changes in formal international inflows have been mixed in the past two weeks, with 11 of 29 interviewed exchange offices reporting increased levels, 5 reporting decreased levels, and 13 reporting no change. Out of the 29 interviewed, 19 indicated that formal remittance levels had not returned to pre-COVID-19 levels, while 10 indicated that they had. Meanwhile, given diverging exchange rates between northern and southern areas and [high fees for money transfers](#) from southern to northern areas, remittance transfers within Yemen are also likely to be below average. More recently, the Central Bank of Yemen [closed all money transfer markets at the end of September](#) according to the Cash Consortium of Yemen, with the aim of implementing a single transfer market in early October to help prevent further depreciation of the currency. Meanwhile, according to [UNICEF](#), the last social welfare fund payment occurred in late June/July 2020.

In September 2020, WFP targeted [8.2 million beneficiaries](#) with humanitarian food assistance. Of these, approximately 5.9 million people were targeted with in-kind food, 1.6 million were targeted with commodity vouchers, and 670,000 were targeted with cash transfers. Since April 2020, beneficiaries in northern Houthi-controlled areas have been reached with an estimated 80 percent ration every other month instead of monthly. Fuel shortages in northern areas are resulting in some disruptions to assistance distributions at the district level, though no major disruptions to distribution activities have been reported. WFP also provided cash transfers to over 85,000 beneficiaries in September as part of food-for-assets (FFA) projects.

The WFP collects monthly data on food security indicators in Yemen via its mVAM mobile phone survey. While important for monitoring, it is important to note that these surveys are not representative at the governorate or national level. Furthermore, only those who own cell phones are sampled, which is likely to be a source of response bias. Generally, those with cell phones may be expected to be better off than those without, but variable geographical coverage across each governorate prevents the ability to infer the likely direction of bias at the governorate or national level. As a result, broad trends over time are more reliable than the absolute values of the indicators themselves. In September 2020, the proportion of households reporting "poor" food consumption as measured by the Food Consumption Score (FCS) — a composite measure of both quantity and quality of food consumed in the past seven days — [increased by 2 percentage points](#) at the national level relative to August. Despite some month-to-month volatility, the percentage reporting "poor" FCS has been generally increasing since February 2020. The use of food consumption-based coping strategies as measured by the reduced coping strategies index (rCSI) was stable between August and September at the national level. Indicators were worse among internally displaced persons (IDPs), particularly in Lahij, Sana'a, and Al Jawf.

No recent nutrition SMART surveys have been conducted. Though nutrition screening and admissions data is confounded by a variety of factors—including changes in the number, capacity, and location of treatment sites, changes in reporting

rates among existing sites, and changes in the number of people seeking treatment—trends can still be useful to monitor. It should be noted that, according to the Nutrition Cluster, admissions trends are currently difficult to interpret due to low reporting rates from partners in the second half of 2020, and significant month-to-month volatility exists in these figures even when reporting rates are relatively high. The Nutrition Cluster also reported that attendance was still reduced in September due primarily to COVID-19, but that attendance was only around 10 percent reduced as of August.

From June to September 2020, admissions for Moderate Acute Malnutrition (MAM) among children under five increased by 22 percent according to the Nutrition Cluster's [November analysis](#). However, this increasing trend is similar to the trend recorded last year, and absolute levels of MAM admissions in 2020 are also similar to levels recorded last year. However, after crude adjustment for reporting rate, levels of MAM admissions are slightly higher in August and September 2020 relative to 2019, though adjusted levels around June were similar. While reporting rates regarding admissions for Severe Acute Malnutrition (SAM) remain very low (introducing greater potential for bias given that reporting areas are likely not representative of all areas), crude adjustment for reporting rate shows an increasing trend in SAM admissions with and without complications, following the trend observed last year. After crude adjustment, admissions of SAM without complications are slightly lower than levels recorded last year, while admissions of SAM with complications are similar. Meanwhile, according to [WHO nutrition surveillance in August](#), MAM prevalence (measured by MUAC due to COVID-19 prevention protocols) among children screened at non-representative sentinel sites across 107 priority districts increased from 18 percent in April and May 2020 to around 22 percent from June to August. Meanwhile, SAM prevalence among those screened increased from 5 percent throughout the first half of 2020 to around 8 percent from June to August. While increasing MAM admissions as well as increasing MAM and SAM prevalence among those screened at sentinel sites could be an indication of a worsening nutrition situation, trends are not deviating substantially from those recorded last year, based on limited available evidence. Further monitoring through the end of 2020 will be important to understand if rates continue to increase (which would be of concern) or begin to decrease again as per what has been observed in the past.

Currently, the recent and ongoing harvests in some regions are expected to be providing some limited seasonal support as households access small amounts of food from own-production and income from agricultural labor opportunities. In many areas, households are also accessing some seasonal food and income from livestock products and livestock sales. Poor households across the country are also expected to be accessing some income from casual labor opportunities, petty trade, remittances, and humanitarian cash transfers. However, access to income is expected to be below average overall due to below-average remittances, ongoing fuel shortages, increased competition for available income-earning opportunities, and the absence of any social welfare fund payment since July 2020. Given rising food prices, food access is expected to be increasingly constrained for many poor market-dependent households. In northern areas, the ongoing cuts to humanitarian assistance are expected to be further reducing access to food. In this environment, the absence of school feeding programs since the middle of the year are likely further stretching households' resources. Available information suggests that the majority of Yemenis face at least moderate food consumption gaps or are engaging in negative livelihoods-based coping strategies such as selling productive assets in order to meet their food needs. Widespread Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes persist even in the presence of ongoing humanitarian food assistance, with an increasing number of worst-affected households expected to be facing Emergency (IPC Phase 4) or Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) outcomes following cuts to humanitarian assistance in northern areas and in areas where food prices are rising quickly and households have exhausted available coping strategies. Additionally, key informants report that some better-off households are likely exhausting strategies such as selling assets, spending savings, and purchasing food on credit. In Aden, recent information from key informants suggest that some poor households are still relying on these strategies, with Stressed! (IPC Phase 2!) outcomes likely at the area level. Overall, FEWS NET estimates that 17-19 million people need emergency food assistance, with poor households and IDPs likely worst affected.

### *Assumptions*

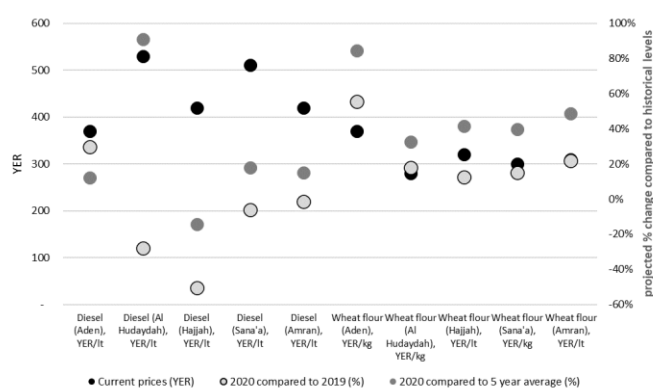
The most likely scenario for the October 2020 to May 2021 period is based on the following national-level assumptions:

- Conflict is anticipated to continue at current high levels in western areas of Yemen. Access constraints are expected to persist in conflict-affected areas and delays at security checkpoints between northern and southern areas are expected to continue. In the south, progress toward implementation of the Riyadh agreement is expected to remain slow, given historical patterns.



- Given current trends, the total number of COVID-19 cases is expected to continue to increase throughout the projection period. Currently enacted COVID-19 control measures—including increased screening and quarantine measures at ports and restrictions at land borders—are expected to remain in place. Restrictions on businesses and public gatherings are likely to remain lifted throughout most of the projection period.
- Given current patterns of people returning to work as well as expectations for recovering global oil prices through at least May 2021, some gradual economic recovery is expected in Saudi Arabia throughout the projection period. As a result, levels of remittances to Yemen are expected to gradually recover throughout the projection period, though will likely remain below average given prolonged global economic impacts of COVID-19. However, this depends on the absence of a second wave of infection and renewed lockdown measures in Saudi Arabia. Meanwhile, remittances and money transfers within Yemen—and particularly transfers from southern to northern areas—are expected to remain reduced throughout the scenario period due to disparate monetary policies and exchange rates between northern and southern areas which are resulting in higher fees for transfers.
- Given recent trends according to data from the US Energy Information Administration, oil production and export levels in 2020 are likely to be below average and only slightly higher than 2019 levels. Given past production trends despite ambitious targets, oil production and export levels through May 2021 are most likely to be similar to levels in 2020. Given expectations for recovering global oil prices, foreign exchange earnings from oil exports through at least May 2021 are expected to recover to levels close to those in early 2020, though will remain below average.
- Given expectations for reduced revenue from oil exports, reduced remittances, and reduced humanitarian aid inflows, severe foreign currency shortages are expected to persist throughout the scenario period. Informal markets will continue to play a key role in regulating access to foreign currency. No large deposit of foreign currency (similar to the 2 billion USD deposit made by Saudi Arabia in early 2018) is expected in the scenario period.
- Due to the impacts of protracted conflict and severe foreign currency shortages, macroeconomic conditions are likely to continue deteriorating through at least May 2021. In southern areas, the average value of the YER is expected to depreciate throughout the projection period, reaching levels between 950 – 1050 YER/USD in the February to May 2021 period. In northern areas, the average value of the YER is expected to depreciate at a slower rate throughout the projection period, reaching levels between 650 – 700 YER/USD in the February to May 2021 period. The gap between exchange rates in the north and south is expected to continue widening throughout the projection period. This will likely lead to increase use of hard currency like the Saudi Riyal as the value of the YER is further eroded. Projections assume that a weaker US dollar and ongoing interventions by both CBY-Aden and CBY-Sana'a will limit the extent of currency depreciation to some extent.
- Due to persistent government revenue and currency shortages, income from civil servant salaries will likely remain below average throughout the projection period. Payment will likely continue to be erratic or absent in many areas.
- Income from non-agricultural labor opportunities is expected to remain below average due to eroded purchasing power among those who hire labor.
- Food imports are expected to continue, though at lower levels than what has been observed thus far in 2020, with month to month volatility likely. This is based on the expectation that traders will face increasing difficulties

**Figure 3.** Projected price ranges relative to historical levels through May 2021



Source: FAO and WFP (observed) and FEWS NET (projections)

accessing sufficient foreign currency due to continued currency depreciation, below-average levels of remittances, and lack of government revenue. However, suspension of the import financing mechanism and/or a sharp and sustained decline in levels of food imports to levels significantly lower than those observed in the first half of 2020 is not expected in the projection period, due to the likelihood that authorities will continue to obtain some revenue, which will be used to prioritize the national food supply. However, there remains uncertainty around available revenue and this, coupled with the expectation of no external budget support, signals that there remains a risk for sharper declines than currently anticipated (see “Events that Might Change the Outlook” table below).

- Fuel imports through the Red Sea Ports are expected to continue at recently reduced levels in the near term (1-3 months), given recent trends and no indication that the parties are closer to an agreement. As a result, fuel shortages and high fuel prices are likely to continue in northern Houthi-controlled areas in the near term, though with occasional temporary increases in availability likely when a fuel shipment is received. Fuel imports through the port of Aden are also expected to continue to be blocked in the near term given limited government revenue and consequent inability of government to respond to protesters’ demands. In the medium term, it is expected that mounting pressure to permit fuel imports to resume will result in alleviation of shortages.
- Informal trade of food and livestock across land borders is expected to continue at reduced levels relative to the pre-conflict period.
- Food prices are expected to continue increasing throughout the scenario period (Figure 3), attributed mostly to continued depreciation of the currency. During this time, additional upward pressure on prices is expected due to high fuel prices in times of shortage, gradual and continued reduction of in-country food supply due to lower import levels, and progression of the agricultural lean season. The IMF projects that average annual inflation will be higher in 2021 (31 percent) than in 2020 (26 percent).
- Livestock body conditions are expected to remain average throughout the scenario period. Milk production is expected to be above-average due to increased fodder production.
- Harvesting of vegetables, fruits, grains, and cash crops (qat, coffee) is expected in some livelihood zones during the scenario period. Favorable precipitation throughout 2020 is expected to have supported crop production, with production levels expected to be similar to or better than last year. However, overall production levels of food crops are expected to remain below average due to the long-term impacts of conflict on the agricultural sector. According to information on current locust presence from FAO, locust presence is expected to continue to reduce throughout the scenario period.
- Income from agricultural labor opportunities will likely remain below average throughout the projection period due to reduced purchasing power among those who hire labor and increased reliance on labor from family members. However, demand for agricultural labor will increase seasonally due to the peak labor demand period in many areas from October 2020 to January 2021. Income from civil salary payments are expected to remain below-average, particularly in southern areas due to constrained government revenue. Based on historical patterns, social welfare fund payments are expected around November 2020 and March 2021, though uncertainty around timing exists.
- Fishing along the Red Sea coast and the Gulf of Aden coast will likely remain below pre-conflict levels due to the impacts of protracted conflict including significantly above-average fuel prices, reduced capacity to purchase fishing assets, and limited access to fishing grounds.
- Cumulative rainfall during the beginning of the 2021 rainy season from March-May 2021 is expected to be below average due the presence of La Niña conditions through early 2021. A typical risk of flooding related to extreme precipitation events exists during this time. Risk of water- and vector-borne diseases such as cholera, malaria, and dengue, are also expected to be elevated during this time.
- Throughout the scenario period, beneficiaries reached by WFP with humanitarian food assistance in northern Houthi-controlled areas are expected to continue receive distributions of assistance only every other month. Beneficiaries in other areas are expected to continue receiving distributions monthly. Some delays in deliveries are expected as humanitarian partners will continue to face restrictions on movement as well as fuel shortages. Access

to humanitarian assistance is expected to be temporarily constrained at times and in areas where conflict or flooding (during the rainy season in March-May 2021) impacts travel routes.

- Schools are expected to reopen in October and remain open through the end of the school year in June. WFP is expected to assist some 740,000 students across the country.
- Nutrition support programs including for treatment of moderate acute malnutrition (MAM) and severe acute malnutrition (SAM) are expected to continue operating at current capacity.
- Due to the current funding environment, partial closure of some humanitarian programs and services is expected. Given previous warnings by humanitarian actors, programs and activities most likely to be impacted include emergency distribution of shelter kits, basic household items, cash for rent, food and medicine, basic healthcare and livelihood support for refugees, and legal assistance and psychosocial support for IDPs.

### *Most Likely Food Security Outcomes*

Throughout the projection period, ongoing conflict and worsening macroeconomic conditions are expected to continue disrupting livelihoods and constraining access to food and income. Overall, access to income is expected to remain close to current below-average levels throughout much of the scenario period. Households dependent on remittances are expected to experience some increased income from that source, and access to income from agricultural labor opportunities will be at seasonally high levels in some regions. However, households dependent on fuel for their livelihoods and those who receive civil servant salary payments in southern areas are likely to experience reductions in income-earning throughout the scenario period. Meanwhile, it is unlikely that wages will be able to fully keep pace with inflation, with the real value of wages expected to decrease in some areas. Given this and rising food prices, household food access will likely be increasingly constrained for many poor households. While below-average harvests will provide some poor rural households with limited food from own-consumption and income from crop sales, stocks are not expected to last beyond a few months in many cases. In northern Houthi-controlled areas where beneficiaries of humanitarian assistance are expected to continue receiving reduced levels of assistance, access to food is expected to be most severely constrained.

In some areas that have recently or currently harvested, sources of food from own crops and livestock will likely be exhausted and seasonally unavailable during the early months of 2021. Poor households will be fully dependent on markets for their food and will be relying on increasingly constrained resources due to limited expandability of income-earning and coping. Most areas of western Yemen are expected to be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) throughout the projection period. However, given available data and information suggesting that relatively higher proportions of the population may already be facing worse outcomes alongside expectations for seasonal deterioration during local lean seasons, area-level Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected to emerge in Amran and Hajjah around April 2020. An increase in the scale and severity of acute food insecurity is expected in other areas, with additional households likely to deteriorate to Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and worst-affected households likely to deteriorate to Emergency (IPC Phase 4) or worse outcomes, particularly in areas where assistance has been cut. In Aden, deterioration to Crisis (IPC Phase 3) is expected as an increasing number of poor households exhaust their savings, assets, and ability to purchase food on credit. During this time, IDP populations and poor households remaining in conflict zones will likely continue to face the most severe food security outcomes. Approximately 17–19 million people are expected to need humanitarian assistance to prevent consumption gaps and protect livelihoods.

In a worst-case scenario, significant declines in commercial imports or conflict that cuts off food supply for a prolonged period of time would likely lead to food security outcomes in line with Famine (IPC Phase 5). Given that this significant and prolonged disruption is not expected during the projection period, Famine (IPC Phase 5) is *not* the most likely scenario. However, even in the absence of a sudden shock, the food security situation in Yemen is progressively deteriorating, raising the risk that Famine (IPC Phase 5) could occur should there be a more significant and prolonged disruption to imports.



*Events that Might Change the Outlook*

Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario:

| Area                                    | Event                                                                        | Impact on food security outcomes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| National                                | Major parties to conflict achieve a lasting ceasefire                        | In time, food access for many households would begin to improve as prices of staple food commodities decline, household access to food and income begins to return to normal, and IDPs begin to return to their areas of origin. However, widespread improvement in food security outcomes would not occur before the economy fully stabilizes and major government functions and livelihood activities are able to resume.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| National                                | CBY in Aden suspends the letters of credit import financing mechanism        | <p>This would likely result in further depreciation of the currency and higher prices for food, fuel, and medicine. The cost of importing these goods would increase in the near term as traders/importers lose access to a preferential exchange rate, with increased costs transmitted to retail prices. Traders will likely increase use of informal financial networks as an immediate response, which would result in import financing gaps and reduced import levels in the near term if alternate sources of foreign currency are insufficient.</p> <p>Overall, this would increase the likelihood of a sudden reduction in food import levels (see below), though uncertainty exists. Even in the absence of this, food availability in the country would be impacted over time, though the timing and magnitude of impacts is uncertain and dependent on other factors including any alternate measures enacted by CBY authorities and humanitarian actors.</p> <p>Given limited ability for households to compensate for rising prices through expansion of income-earning, this would further constrain access to food for many poor households. An increase in the number of households facing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes would be likely, with area-level deterioration to Emergency (IPC Phase 4) possible in areas where food availability is significantly reduced for a prolonged period (4-6 months).</p> |
| National                                | Food import levels fall dramatically                                         | Food prices would quickly rise and, if prolonged, food availability on local markets would decline. Food security outcomes would worsen with area-level deterioration to Emergency (IPC Phase 4) possible in areas where food availability is significantly reduced for a prolonged period. In a worst-case scenario where food supply is cut off from particular areas for a prolonged period of time, Famine (IPC Phase 5) remains possible.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| National                                | Yemen receives another large injection of hard currency                      | The exchange rate would be expected to stabilize while the deposit lasts, with food imports likely to return to previously observed levels. While food prices would not be expected to return to previous levels, further price increases would be moderated. As a result, purchasing power would remain reduced for most poor households in areas where price increases have occurred.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| National, but especially northern areas | Further reductions in assistance benefits or delays in assistance deliveries | If further reductions in humanitarian assistance benefits or delays in deliveries occur, access to food would be further reduced in affected areas. In northern areas currently receiving assistance distributions every other month, deterioration would be more rapid. In other areas, worst affected households would also be expected to face increasingly constrained food access and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

|                       |                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Red Sea coastal areas | Decaying SAFER oil tanker causes a spill | Although this event is not assessed to be highly likely during the scenario period, the risk of this occurring is increasing over time. Should this occur, destruction of fish and fishing grounds would further damage livelihoods along the Red Sea coast. Households dependent on fishing would be expected to face increasingly constrained food access, with an increasing number expected to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes. |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## AREAS OF CONCERN

### Hajjah Governorate

#### Current Situation

The primary crops grown in Hajjah's two main livelihood zones—for own consumption and sale—are wheat, sorghum, millet, and maize. Qat also provides an important source of income for better-off households and provides labor opportunities for the poor. Poor households earn income primarily from labor opportunities, supplemented by crop and livestock sales, firewood sales, and remittances. The population of Hajjah governorate is around 2.5 million according to FSAC.

The current situation period coincides with the end of the harvest for wheat and fodder in the Western and Central Highlands (LZ-13) and the end of milk production in the Western Coastal Plain (LZ-14). However, typical livelihood strategies and traditional sources of food and income remain disrupted by protracted conflict.

According to data from the Civilian Impact Monitoring Project (CIMP), districts that have experienced the greatest civilian casualties and infrastructure and livelihoods damage during the protracted conflict include Abs, Harad, Midi, Al Jamimah, Mustaba, and Bakil Al Mir. Multiple displacements have occurred in some of these and other districts over the past five years according to the Norwegian Refugee Council (NRC), separating households from livelihoods and assets. According to data from the Armed Conflict Location and Event Monitoring Project (ACLED) and Intelyse, levels of ground conflict have remained low in Hajjah throughout 2020. However, coalition airstrikes continue to affect the governorate, though at reduced levels compared to that recorded throughout most of 2019. According to CIMP, airstrikes from January to mid-July 2020 most notably impacted civilians in the districts of Abs, Midi, and Harad. During this period, CIMP reported 28 incidents that may have caused civilian harm (including displacements, movements restrictions, restricted access to infrastructure, or loss of life and livelihoods), compared to 78 during the same time period in 2019. From mid-July to late October 2020, 31 more airstrike incidents have been reported in the districts of Harad, Mahliyah, Abs, Sirwa, Midi, Razih, Bart al Anan, and Haryan according to data from Intelyse. According to a news report in October 2020, road closures due to conflict were preventing some farmers in Midi district from selling their agricultural produce in markets of neighboring cities, with this year being the third consecutive year that watermelon grown by local farmers has rotted in fields due to restricted market access as a result of the protracted conflict.

In April 2020 and again in late July into early August, heavy rainfall caused flooding in Hajjah, with tens of thousands of households affected. According to ACAPS Yemen, April flooding affected approximately 2,800 displaced people in Hajjah—particularly in Abs district. Flooding destroyed tents and shelters at IDP sites, leaving people in need of emergency assistance, while at the same time damaging roads and disrupting humanitarian access for the provision of aid distributions and conducting needs assessments. Later in the season, Hajjah was one of the governorates worst affected by flooding in July/August according to UNOCHA, with at least 5,353 households (around 30,000 people) affected. Flooding damaged infrastructure, destroyed homes and shelters, and killed livestock in worst-affected areas.

**Figure 4.** Reference map for Hajjah governorate



Source: FEWS NET

The parallel market exchange rate in Hajjah has remained fairly stable throughout 2020, increasing only 2 percent from January to September 2020, to reach 600 YER/USD according to data from FAO. The price of imported wheat flour has also remain fairly stable from June to September, at around 317-320 YER/kg. However, this stabilization comes after wheat flour prices increased 5 percent from March to May. Considering other staple food items as well, the cost of the Minimum Food Basket (MFB) increased by 3 percent from August to September, reaching levels 6.8 percent below the national average.

Production levels in the recent cereal harvest remain significantly below pre-conflict levels. This year, some localized crop damage likely occurred due to flooding in April and in July/August. From August to September, prices of local sorghum and millet increased by 5 and 3 percent respectively, after generally declining in the summer months alongside the harvests according to data from FAO. Prices of local sorghum and millet in September 2020 were 22 and 24 percent lower, respectively, than prices in September 2019. Meanwhile, prices of vegetables have been more volatile throughout 2020. From August to September 2020 the prices of vegetables increased for onion (36 percent), tomato (62 percent), potato (13 percent), chili (8 percent), while the price of okra decreased by 4 percent. In September, prices were generally higher than the same time last year, for onion (18 percent), tomato (51 percent) and potato (4 percent), while prices were lower for chilly (26 percent) and okra (12 percent). According to FAO, high prices may be partially attributable to the rising cost of fuel, which is increasing costs of irrigation and transport, as well as from seasonal reductions in supply in neighboring areas.

Meanwhile, after declining 5 percent from June to July, there has been a recovery in agricultural labor wages which have increased by 7 percent from July to September according to FAO. As a result, the terms of trade between staple wheat flour and agricultural labor wages increased by 4 percent in Hajjah from August to September, driven by wages (Figure 5). Wages for agricultural labor in September 2020 were 18 percent higher than the same time last year. Meanwhile, wages and terms of trade for casual laborers remained stable from August to September.

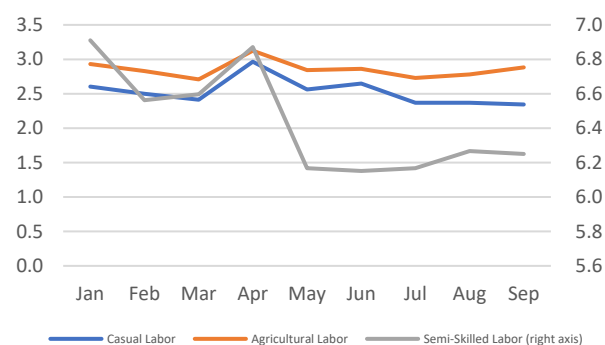
Fuel shortages in northern governorates have impacted Hajjah, with the prices of diesel and petrol increasing sharply by 80 percent and 128 percent, respectively, between May and June 2020, according to data from FAO. Following this, prices of diesel and petrol declined by 6 and 23 percent, respectively, from June to September. Despite the persistent high prices, the prices of diesel and petrol in September were 4 and 13 percent lower, respectively, than in September 2019 when fuel shortages were also occurring.

Fish were sporadically available in September 2020 according to FAO, attributed to typical seasonal winds and to fuel shortages disrupting supply chains. However, availability has improved in September, with prices from August to September remaining steady or decreasing slightly. Meanwhile, after generally declining from January to May/June 2020 likely due to COVID-19 related export restrictions to markets in Saudi Arabia, livestock prices in Hajjah have recovered somewhat from June to September 2020, despite some month-to-month volatility during that period. Most recently, in September, the prices of livestock rose significantly for sheep and goat; prices for sheep increased by 12 percent (both six-month-old and twelve-month-old) while prices for goats rose by 21 percent (six-month-old) and 4 percent (twelve-month-old). This is expected to support access to income for poor households selling small livestock.

Due to impacts of the global oil market and COVID-19 on Saudi Arabia's economy and to high fees on money transfers from southern to northern areas of Yemen, it is likely that income from remittances are currently below average. The recent increase in agricultural labor wages and in livestock prices is likely providing some relief to poor households who continue to rely on these sources of income, though terms of trade have generally been declining over time.

According to [WFP mVAM data](#), the percentage of households registering "poor" FCS in Hajjah (likely mostly Hajjah City) has increased from 6.6 to 12 percent from March to September 2020. Throughout the same period, the percentage of

**Figure 5.** Terms of trade between 4kg of wheat flour (equivalent to daily caloric needs for a household of seven) and one day's labor wages in Hajjah, January-September 2020



Source: FAO

households registering “borderline” FCS has increased from 22 to 40 percent. This may be attributed, at least partially, to the reduced frequency of humanitarian food assistance distributions in the governorate since April 2020. Despite this, mean rCSI has remained fairly stable in Hajjah throughout 2020, though at levels consistently among the highest in Yemen. In September 2020, mean rCSI was 23.3 among displaced and 23.1 among non-displaced households.

According to nutrition SMART surveys conducted in 2019, the prevalence of Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM) as measured by weight-for-height z-score (WHZ) in Hajjah was 15.8 percent (95% CI: 12.1–20.3) in the Northern Interior Lowland, 19.8 percent (95% CI: 16.1–24.3) in the Western Lowland, and 17.1 percent in the Southern Lowland, surpassing the WHO threshold of “very high” malnutrition prevalence. Though current representative data on malnutrition levels are not available, [WHO nutrition surveillance in August](#) reports that SAM prevalence among children screened in monitored districts remained stable at an average of 3-4 percent from January to May 2020. As of August 2020, SAM and MAM prevalence among children screened exceeded 10 and 25 percent, respectively, in worst-affected Abs district.

Conflict and insecurity continue to erode and constrain typical livelihood activities. Additionally, flooding, fuel shortages, and COVID-19 have been additional shocks in recent months, further impacting households’ access to food and income. Currently, poor households are expected to be accessing some food and income from livestock products and sales. In highland areas which harvested later, households are also currently expected to be accessing some food from own production and some income from crop sales. At the same time, poor households in Hajjah are expected to be earning some income from casual and agricultural labor, remittances, and other traditional sources such as firewood sales in order to purchase food from markets. However, food prices remain significantly above average levels. Many households are also continuing to receive food from humanitarian assistance distributions, though they are effectively receiving 40 percent of their food needs since the reductions in April. Overall, access to food and income is expected to be below average overall, with Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes likely. Humanitarian food assistance, although less frequent, is likely preventing worse outcomes among beneficiaries.

### *Assumptions*

In addition to the above national-level assumptions, projected outcomes for Hajjah governorate are based on the following:

- Conflict will likely continue at current levels, with Abs, Harad, and Haryan districts most affected. Levels of ground conflict will likely remain lower than in 2019, though trends in conflict remain unpredictable. As a result, levels of population displacement are expected to remain high, though lower than in 2019.
- Qat will likely be harvested between February and March. In some areas, cotton will likely be harvested between January and February. During this time, income from agricultural labor will likely increase seasonally, but remain below average levels.
- Milk production is expected to be seasonally available through October/November 2020 and again from March/April to May/June 2021. However, access to own-produced milk particularly in the Western Coastal Plains is expected to be below average levels due to significant loss of livestock holdings resulting from population displacements and increased reliance on livestock sales for income over the years. Livestock sales are expected to continue normally in the scenario period, increasing as the lean season progresses.
- Fishing activities in the western coastal areas in Abs, Haradh, and Medi districts will likely remain limited due to insecurity and higher costs of fuel and equipment.

### *Most Likely Food Security Outcomes*

Given access to food and income from own crops and livestock, current levels of humanitarian assistance providing approximately 40 percent of needs for a large percent of the population, and some income from other sources including agricultural and casual labor, livestock, and remittances, Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes are expected to persist through the October 2020 to January 2021 period. However, during this time, access to food and income is expected to decline alongside the progression of the typical lean season as household food stocks deplete. Access to markets will also likely continue to be constrained by existing road closures, insecurity, and increasing transport and transaction costs.

In the February to May 2021 period, increasing food consumption gaps are likely for a significant proportion of the population. Given cuts to humanitarian food assistance, many households will likely be increasingly unable to compensate through available livelihood and coping strategies. An increasing number of households are expected to face widening consumption gaps and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) or worse outcomes in April and May 2021 when sources of food and income are seasonally low, with Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes likely at the area level during that time.

### Events that Might Change the Outlook

Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario:

| Area   | Event                                                                        | Impact on food security outcomes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hajjah | Humanitarian food assistance rations are restored to early 2020 levels       | Household food access for poor and displaced households would improve significantly. While impacts of other shocks persist—including conflict and macroeconomic deterioration—household food gaps would likely narrow substantially, resulting in significant improvements in acute food security outcomes to Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) for many households.              |
| Hajjah | Further reductions in assistance benefits or delays in assistance deliveries | If further reductions in humanitarian assistance benefits or delays in deliveries occur, access to food would be further reduced for a significant proportion of the population. Additional households would be expected to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes in the projection period, with area-level deterioration to Emergency (IPC Phase 4) more rapid. |

### Amran Governorate

#### Current Situation

Agriculture is the most important livelihood activity for the vast majority of the population in Amran. The primary food crops produced for household consumption in [Amran's main livelihood zone](#) are sorghum, wheat, and barley, while qat, sorghum, and barley are also produced for sale. Livestock also contribute significantly to households' total food and income. Though poor households harvest some crops for own consumption, they are mostly dependent on market purchases for food. The main source of income for poor households is agricultural labor, followed by some crop sales and small livestock sales. Other sources of income are derived from remittances and gifts. The population of Amran is around 1.2 million according to FSAC.

Levels of conflict in Amran are low compared to the situation in neighboring governorates (Hajjah, Sa'dah, Al Jawf). While there have been some incidents of conflict in Amran during 2020—predominantly in the form of airstrikes—fighting has not directly impacted civilian lives or livelihoods to the same extent as elsewhere. However, typical livelihood strategies and traditional sources of food and income remain disrupted by the indirect impacts of protracted conflict in the country. Since the outbreak of the war, agricultural production in Amran has been declining as high fuel prices have increased production costs, thus reducing income for farmers and eroding their purchasing power. According to the Berghof Foundation, the [poverty rate in Amran](#) is among the highest in Yemen (along with Hajjah and Al Hudaydah), with unemployment also very high. According to ACAPS Yemen, rural populations in [Al Ashah, Al Qafalah, Suwayr and Maswar districts](#) of Amran were already particularly vulnerable prior to the crisis, due to pre-existing poverty and historic lack of development.

**Figure 6.** Reference map for Amran governorate



Source: FEWS NET



The parallel market exchange rate in Amran increased 5 percent from January to June 2020 but has since declined 3 percent to reach 590 YER/USD in September according to data from FAO. Despite this, the price of imported wheat flour has been generally increasing since May/June, and most recently increased 5 percent from August to September, to reach the highest prices recorded this year. Considering other staple food items as well, the cost of the Minimum Food Basket (MFB) increased by 6.5 percent from August to September, reaching levels close to the national average.

Production levels in the recent cereal harvest remain significantly below pre-conflict levels. According to FAO, prices of locally produced grains have been volatile in recent months. From July to August, prices of locally produced sorghum and barley declined by 10 and 12 percent, respectively, before each increasing by 9 percent from August to September. Prices of local sorghum and barley in September 2020 were 25 and 2 percent lower, respectively, than prices in September 2019. Meanwhile, prices of vegetables have been generally increasing since June. Prices increased significantly from August to September 2020, for onion by (22 percent), tomato (76 percent), potato (5 percent), and chili (121 percent), while the price of okra dropped by 18 percent. In September, prices were higher than the same time last year for onion (53 percent) and potato (50 percent), while prices were similar for okra and potato and lower for chilly (32 percent) and okra (12 percent). According to FAO, high prices may be partially attributable to the rising cost of fuel, which is increasing costs of irrigation and transport, as well as from seasonal reductions in supply in neighboring areas.

Meanwhile, wages for agricultural and casual labor increased by 6 and 4 percent, respectively, from August to September according to data from FAO. Despite this, the terms of trade between wages and staple wheat flour remained relatively stable (increased by 1 percent for agricultural labor and decreased by 1.5 percent for casual labor) due to the rising wheat flour prices during the same time.

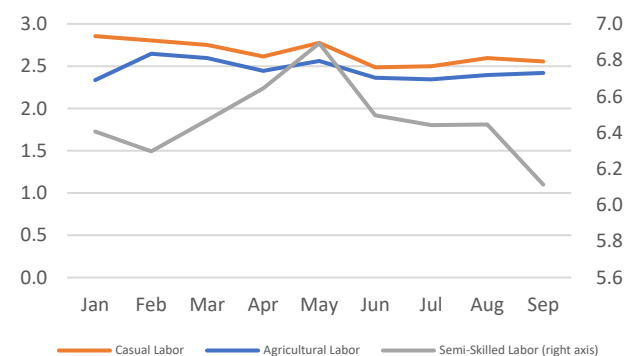
Fuel shortages have impacted Amran, with the prices of diesel and petrol increasing by 10 percent and 40 percent, respectively, between May and June 2020, according to data from FAO. Despite a temporary decrease in prices from June to July, prices of diesel and petrol have been increasing since then. Despite the persistently high fuel prices, the price of diesel in September 2020 was 2 percent lower, while petrol remained 1.4 percent higher compared to September 2019 when fuel shortages were also occurring.

Fuel shortages and typical seasonal winds have reduced the availability of monitored fish types, resulting in above-average fish prices in Amran during August. However, in September, availability improved somewhat according to FAO, while retail prices were stable. Meanwhile, goat prices were stable (0.5-1 percent increase) from August to September 2020, sheep prices increased slightly (2.5-3 percent increase), and chicken prices decreased 5 percent.

Due to impacts of the global oil market and COVID-19 on Saudi Arabia's economy and to high fees on money transfers from southern to northern areas of Yemen, it is likely that income from remittances are currently below average. The recent increase in labor wages is likely compensating somewhat for rising food prices, though terms of trade have generally been declining over time (Figure 7).

According to [WFP mVAM data](#), the percentage of households registering "poor" FCS in Amran (likely mostly Amran and Shaharah districts) was 19 percent in September 2020. Despite significant month-to-month volatility, this percentage has generally increased since it was recorded at 12 percent in May 2020. Throughout the same period, the percentage of households reporting "borderline" FCS has remained stable (increased from 23 to 25 percent). This may be attributed, at least partially, to the reduced frequency of humanitarian food assistance distributions in the governorate since April 2020. Despite this, mean rCSI has remained fairly stable in Amran throughout 2020. In September 2020, mean rCSI was 21.7 among displaced and 19.1 among non-displaced households.

**Figure 7.** Terms of trade between 4kg of wheat flour (equivalent to daily caloric needs for a household of seven) and one day's labor wages in Amran, January-September 2020



Source: FAO

No recent nutrition SMART surveys have been conducted. According to a SMART survey conducted in 2018, GAM prevalence in Amran was 7.4 percent, which is considered “medium” according to WHO classification. According to [WHO nutrition surveillance in August](#), SAM prevalence among children screened in monitored districts remained stable at an average of 2-3 percent from January to April 2020 before increasing to 6 percent in May. However, a very limited geographical area of Amran is monitored, with monitored areas expected to be worst affected relative to the rest of Amran.

Typical livelihood activities continue to be constrained due the impacts of protracted conflict on Yemen’s economy, increasing prices of agricultural inputs and fuel and reducing consumer demand. Fuel shortages and COVID-19 have been additional shocks in recent months, further impacting households’ access to food and income. Currently, poor households are expected to be accessing some food and income from livestock products and sales (including from milk, which is typically available through October). Poor households are also expected to be earning some income from casual and agricultural labor, remittances, and other traditional sources such as firewood sales in order to purchase food from markets. However, food prices remain significantly above average levels. Many households are also continuing to receive food from humanitarian assistance distributions, though they are effectively receiving 40 percent of their food needs since the reductions in April. Overall, access to food and income is expected to be below average overall, with Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes likely. Humanitarian food assistance, although less frequent, is likely preventing worse outcomes among beneficiaries.

### *Assumptions*

In addition to the above national-level assumptions, projected outcomes for Amran governorate are based on the following:

- Levels of conflict in Amran are expected to remain low, though trends in conflict remain unpredictable.
- Land preparation, planting, and weeding for the next agricultural season will likely occur between January and May in the Amran Rainfed Sorghum, Barley, Qat, and Livestock Zone. During this time, income from agricultural labor will likely increase seasonally, but remain below average levels.
- Livestock sales are expected to continue normally in the scenario period, increasing as the lean season progresses.

### *Most Likely Food Security Outcomes*

Given access to food from own livestock products, current levels of humanitarian assistance providing approximately 40 percent of needs for a large percent of the population, and some income from other sources including labor and remittances, Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes are expected to persist through the October 2020 to January 2021 period. However, during this time, access to food and income is expected to decline alongside the progression of the typical lean season as household food stocks deplete.

In the February to May 2021 period, increasing food consumption gaps are likely for a significant proportion of the population. Given cuts to humanitarian food assistance, many households will likely be increasingly unable to compensate through available livelihood and coping strategies. An increasing number of households are expected to face widening consumption gaps and Emergency (IPC Phase 4) or worse outcomes in April and May 2021 when sources of food and income are seasonally low, with Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes likely at the area level during that time.

## Events that Might Change the Outlook

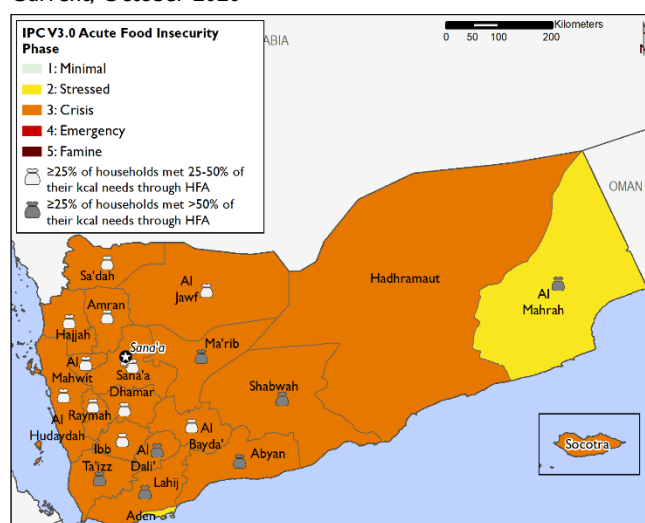
Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario:

| Area  | Event                                                                        | Impact on food security outcomes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Amran | Humanitarian food assistance rations are restored to early 2020 levels       | Household food access for poor and displaced households would improve significantly. While impacts of other shocks persist—including conflict and macroeconomic deterioration—household food gaps would likely narrow substantially, resulting in significant improvements in acute food security outcomes to Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) for many households.              |
| Amran | Further reductions in assistance benefits or delays in assistance deliveries | If further reductions in humanitarian assistance benefits or delays in deliveries occur, access to food would be further reduced for a significant proportion of the population. Additional households would be expected to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes in the projection period, with area-level deterioration to Emergency (IPC Phase 4) more rapid. |

## MOST LIKELY FOOD SECURITY OUTCOMES AND AREAS RECEIVING SIGNIFICANT LEVELS OF HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE\*

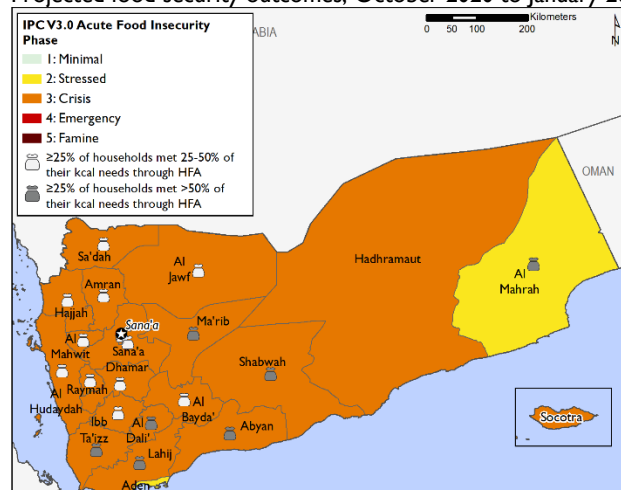
Each of these maps adheres to IPC v3.0 humanitarian assistance mapping protocols and flags where significant levels of humanitarian assistance are being/are expected to be provided. ☐ indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average 25–50 percent of caloric needs from humanitarian food assistance (HFA). ☐ indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average over 50 percent of caloric needs through HFA. This mapping protocol differs from the (!) protocol used in the maps at the top of the report. The use of (!) indicates areas that would likely be at least one phase worse in the absence of current or programmed humanitarian assistance.

Current, October 2020



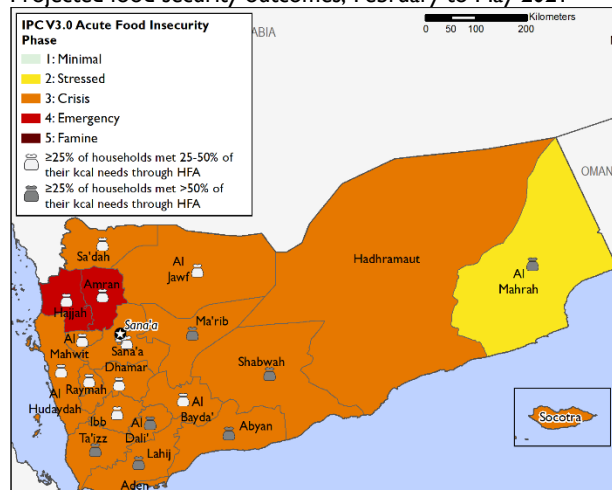
Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, October 2020 to January 2021



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, February to May 2021



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

### ABOUT SCENARIO DEVELOPMENT

To project food security outcomes, FEWS NET develops a set of assumptions about likely events, their effects, and the probable responses of various actors. FEWS NET analyzes these assumptions in the context of current conditions and local livelihoods to arrive at a most likely scenario for the coming eight months. [Learn more here.](#)